

MAKING LIFE- CHANGING DECISIONS

**A ROADMAP TO NAVIGATE THE TWISTS
AND TURNS OF DAILY LIVING AND
DECISION-MAKING.**

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DEDICATION

To my wife, Esther who has been a great support and source of inspiration in this journey to purpose.

To my awesome kids – Shalom, Shiloh, and Salma, who remain a motivation for me to build generations for Christ.

EPIGRAPH

“The scariest place to be is where God is not, no matter how successful. The safest place to be is where God is, no matter how fearful.”

—VICTOR CHUKWU

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PREFACE

After many years of living, I've come to understand the value of making timely decisions and being accountable for the outcomes that follow. But let's face it, in a world filled with distractions, making the right choices is not always easy. That's why I wrote this book.

In these pages, I share my personal experiences and lessons learned about decision-making. From recognizing the importance of careful consideration to understanding the impact of our choices on our future, I offer practical advice on how to navigate life's challenges and make informed decisions that align with our goals and values.

I believe that this book will be beneficial not only to Christians seeking to deepen their faith, but also to anyone seeking guidance and inspiration in their life. Whether you're dealing with a tough situation or simply looking for ways to live a more fulfilling and meaningful life, I hope that the teachings in this book will resonate with you.

Whether you're struggling with a difficult decision or seeking guidance on how to make better choices, this book is for

you. I hope that the insights and strategies shared within will inspire and empower you to take charge of your life and make decisions that lead to success and fulfillment.

I want to thank my family, friends, and mentors who supported me throughout this writing process. I also express my gratitude to God for providing me with the wisdom and inspiration to write this book.

May the words in these pages bring you closer to God and help you live a more joyful and purposeful life.

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INTRODUCTION

“YOU WERE BORN LIKE YOUR PARENTS, BUT YOU WILL DIE LIKE YOUR DECISIONS.”— ANONYMOUS

Life is indeed a series of decisions, and we are shaped by the decisions that we make, as well as the ones made on our behalf. One crucial aspect that we have no control over is the family we are born into, which is determined by factors beyond our control, such as genetics and circumstance. However, there are many other aspects of our birth that are the result of decisions made by others: where we were born, the hospital we were born in, and who delivered us. These decisions can have a significant impact on our early lives and shape our future. Ultimately, it is up to us to make the most of the circumstances we are given and to make decisions that will lead to a fulfilling life.

I remember the unique story around my birth. I am the seventh child out of nine children born to my mother. My younger sisters are twins. I was told the story of how the doctors advised my mother after she gave birth to my elder brother to stop having children. According to them, she had had enough, and they sternly discouraged having more chil-

dren in the family. But apparently, my parents wanted more children, or perhaps I had to come into my family. So when Mom was pregnant with me, she would not go to the hospital because she was afraid of the doctors. She enrolled in the Faith Clinic, which was built and operated by the church my family attended at that time. The clinic was known for adhering to strong faith, instead of administering medical drugs during pregnancy and delivery. This was a very unique method. I was born in that clinic without complications. Glory be to God! However, after many years, the clinic was forced to close down due to complications that had become common among mothers. In short, I had no say in where I was born.

Life comes in phases. In the early phase, decisions are made for you. You are not a mistake. Your family is not a mistake. God decided that you will be born into that family for a purpose. Perhaps Moses wondered, understandably so, why he was born into a Hebrew family, yet, lived with the Egyptians. This was all orchestrated by God. Moses was born at a time when the king of Egypt decreed that all newborn males be killed. However, the godfearing midwives refused to kill the babies, so they were told to just throw them into the water. When Moses was born, his mother tried to hide him for three months, and when they couldn't hide him anymore, he was tossed into the water. It was not a mistake. Instead, it was a calculated move that was made to ensure the child's safety and ultimate destiny. From the natural perspective, he appeared

to be tossed into the water of the Nile River, but in actuality, he was tossed into the king's family.

Moses was thrown into the river on the very day the princess was there. He was later adopted, not just into any Egyptian family, but into Pharaoh's (the king's) family. Moses' adoption into this family was neither by happenstance nor mistake. It was divinely orchestrated. Moses needed access to Pharaoh's family because many years later, he would be sent there to deliver an important message to deliver God's people from slavery. He had to learn the Egyptian language to communicate that message to Pharaoh.

Despite the circumstances surrounding your birth or your present situation, like Moses, you are not a mistake. God planned your life, even before you could make decisions. Now, reaching God's designed destiny for you depends on the decisions you make when you are at the age to do so.

As you progress through life, the number of decisions you have to make tends to increase gradually. While it's often said that we can confidently make random decisions by the age of 25, it's important to note that the brain is continually developing and changing throughout our lifespan. As a result, there isn't a specific age at which the brain can be deemed fully mature. However, some areas of the brain reach maturity at different times during adolescence and early adulthood. For example, the prefrontal cortex, responsible for decision-making, impulse control, and emotional regulation, continues to

develop until the mid-20s. But different individuals can have different rates of brain development and maturation. It is also important to note that many important decisions are made during early adolescence to the young adult age. During this period, you need to be very careful with your decision-making. These life-changing choices can have a significant impact on your future. Your future harvest depends on the seeds of decision you have sown.

Our God is unlimited and timeless. Yet, He gives every man the right to choose. In recent times, young people have argued why God gave us the right to choose when He knows the end from the beginning. This concept has been misunderstood by many who have taken to media platforms to ridicule God's plan for humanity. But the simplest way I explain this to young people is by likening the creation of God to the mastermind of an online video game. The one who made the game knows the end of every path. But the end depends on the player. If you play well, make the right decisions, and take the right path, you will have a good end, but if not, you will lose your life. Imagine the maker of the game standing next to you. Once you make a wrong decision and go on the wrong path, I'm sure he will warn you. Why? Because he knows your path will lead you to the wrong place. God knows the end of every path you can take. But He leaves you to make the decision. If you listen to Him, He will guide you to the

desired destination. If you refuse to listen, the outcome will be undesirable.

King Joash was allowed to decide his future when he went to meet Elisha on his deathbed. Elisha instructed him to open the window and shoot. Then, he told him to shoot the ground. However, the king only fired three times before stopping. Elisha was furious because the king did this. He had a blank check but did not use it to its fullest potential. This serves as a valuable lesson to us all about the importance of maximizing our chances and making the most of the resources we have been given.

Everyone will be given opportunities to make choices. What you do with those opportunities depends on you and the choices you make. The choices you make determine the path you take. The boy (popularly known as the Prodigal Son) decided to take his inheritance from his father and relocate to a strange land. His father respected his decision and gave him what he wanted. How do we know his decision wasn't the best? The outcome was bad. The Prodigal Son realized he had made the wrong decision when he saw the desolate condition of his life. Hence, he changed for the better.

The truth is we have all made wrong choices at one point in our lives. But we can learn from our mistakes and use them as steppingstones to success. The outcome of your life is a reflection of the balance between the good and bad choices you made. I can recall many regrettable choices I made,

but I learned several lessons from my mistakes. They helped to shape my principles for future experiences. One of those days in high school, I decided not to go home directly after school finished. I had become a little more independent and I thought I could decide when I should get home after school. So, that day, I chose to follow my friends to play some soccer on a nearby field. I didn't realize that the environment was not safe. As we played, we were suddenly surrounded by hoodlums who hung around the field to drink and smoke. Before we could say much, we were stripped of valuable personal belongings. I knew I had made the wrong choice and never repeated it.

“The outcome of your life is a reflection of the balance between the good and bad choices you made.

The point is that the decisions we make have a significant impact on the outcome of our destinies. Therefore, in the upcoming chapters, I will delve into each factor that can impact our ability to make sound decisions in critical moments. By exploring these factors in detail, we can equip ourselves to make wiser choices and fulfill our divine calling with confidence.

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FIND GOD

“OUR BEST CHANCE OF FINDING GOD IS TO LOOK IN THE PLACE WHERE WE LEFT HIM.” - MEISTER ECKHART

The Oxford Dictionary defines purpose as “the reason for which something is done or created or for which something exists.” We all have a purpose for which we were created and exist. And we have one common feature: the desire to fulfill our God-ordained purpose. God has a purpose for every man born on the earth. As He told Jeremiah, before we were born, He had a purpose and plan for us to achieve.

A man who cannot determine his purpose in life will pose for anything. Many have done this throughout history because they sought purpose in the wrong places. You cannot find purpose without finding God. Science can explain *how* you were born, but only God can explain *why* you were born. So, if you want to find your purpose, find God. It is possible. The bible says, “*You will seek me and find me when you seek me with all your heart.*” (Jeremiah 29:13 NIV). There is a common saying that explains the importance of God in our

lives: The fish cannot survive outside of water for a long time because it was not made to. The tree cannot survive outside of soil because it was not made to. Similarly, man cannot survive outside of God; he was not made to. We are made in the image of God, and until we collide with Him and bow in surrender, we have not truly begun to live. God is the Author and Finisher of our purpose. Our lives start and end with God. You start, walk, and finish with God. It's beneficial to find a good church, mentor, school, or community to live in, but discovering God for yourself is even more crucial. This serves as the foundation for life and purpose.

“A man who cannot determine his purpose in life will pose for anything”.

FINDING GOD

At the very young age of seven, I was introduced to God. I was born into a very conservative church, popularly known for its strong stance on holiness and purity of heart. My mother was one of the top leaders in the church, while my dad served as one of the protocol officers. So, very early, I was introduced to the routine of Christianity, and I began to learn the rudiments of living a Christian life, though I had not found God. I was already in the choir and was learning the recorder, which is typically the first instrument you play to get acquainted

with music and its vocabulary. I was somewhat like Samuel in the Bible, a young boy who served Eli, the old prophet, whose eyes were already dim, and his children were defiling the altar. One day, God called Samuel, and because Samuel had not found God for himself—he only served in the church—he ran to Eli when he heard a voice calling him. After Eli told him to go lie back in his position two consecutive times, the third time he became sensitive and directed Samuel on how to respond to the call of God. Thank God!

One day, the children's pastor called me after the service, and he explained to me why I needed to be "born-again." That is the process of accepting Christ as my personal Lord and Savior and confessing my sins with faith He will forgive and cleanse me from all sins (though they weren't that many at the time). I could only remember stealing my parents' coins and other people's belongings. But the day my mom found out; she disciplined me in a way I would never forget. So, I did not hesitate to respond to the call of God through my pastor at that time. He led me through the prayer of repentance and salvation. This is the first step in finding God. Yes, I was very young, and might not have fully understood the implication of the journey I started. But it was worth the start. It was the beginning of a lifelong relationship with God, despite many challenges on the road. Have you genuinely surrendered your life to Jesus? Many people are religious but are not regenerated. They go to church, get busy in the church, memorize

the Scriptures, and conform to the traditions, but they have not been converted. Jesus said, unless a man is born again, He cannot experience the kingdom of God, which consists of His purpose and the possibilities.

SEEKING GOD

Being born-again is just the beginning of a relationship and a walk with God. Afterward, we must continually seek God to know His purpose for every phase of our lives. The ultimate purpose of our lives is to glorify God in every sphere He has placed us in. It is an accumulation of fulfilling our little purposes in different phases of our lives. Our walk on the earth is not without distraction, no wonder Jesus taught His disciples to seek *first* the kingdom of God and His righteousness. This act is highly intentional because surely, we will be tempted to seek many other things. We also tend to focus first on money, materialism, mansions, mighty positions, and pleasures. And once these things take away our focus, we lose track of our ultimate purpose on Earth.

“The ultimate purpose of our lives is to glorify God in every sphere He has placed us in.”

Growing up as a young boy, one thing I struggled with was my desire for pleasure. Like every other teenager, the hormones in my body were skyrocketing, even though I was

dedicated to the church. But what helped me was my desire not to stop seeking God, even in my lowest state. David sang, “He lifted me out of the slimy pit, out of the mud and mire; he set my feet on a rock and gave me a firm place to stand. He put a new song in my mouth, a hymn of praise to our God. Many will see and fear the Lord and put their trust in him. Blessed is the one who trusts in the Lord, who does not look to the proud, to those who turn aside to false gods.” (Psalm 40: 2 - 4 NIV) When I graduated from medical school, I pursued an internship job called horsemanship, compulsory one-year training required for all newly graduated doctors. The process was tedious, involving many applications to different accredited hospitals, getting letters of reference from multiple sources, traveling for exams and interviews, and praying for God’s favor. On one such trip to a university outside my state of birth, I stayed with some medical students I was referred to for assistance. On one of those nights, a roommate announced he got a used phone from the market and expressed his shock at the videos he found on it. In our curiosity, we all crowded around him to watch the videos. Amazingly and unfortunately, there were a lot of porn videos. I was introduced to porn videos for the first time. I could not erase those images from my head. When I traveled back home, like a hapless fish on the hooked line, I was so spellbound I decided to look for more porn videos.

The Devil lied to me by encouraging me to watch more. He told me I was mature enough to see them because I was a medical doctor and had been exposed to many things. Well, at first, I believed the lie and engaged in dangerous pleasure by feeding my soul with filth. But on the other hand, I did not stop seeking God. I still had my morning devotions, attended services, and served in my capacity. One day, while listening to music (despite all that, I always listened to strictly gospel music), God caught me with the song “Awake My Soul” by Philip, Craig, and Dean. Read the lyrics of the song. I had heard this song many times, but this time, it sounded markedly different. I believe God wanted to start my cleansing that day, and yes, He did. Alone in my room, I cried and surrendered my heart to God for cleansing. He started to purge me of my uncleanness, and gradually removed my desire for porn. Later, I opened up about it to an accountability partner, which also helped me in the cleansing process.

AWAKE MY SOUL¹

Awake my soul, prepare an entrance for Your glory

And let my heart become a throne for You to dwell

And when I need Your Holy Spirit more than life itself

Then Christ is formed in me

I told my story of transgression and deliverance because I know many young people, even adults, are struggling with one addiction or the other. The last time I did the research

for a talk on pornography, I was shocked at the alarming statistics. I listed some of them below²:

- Over 40 million Americans are regular visitors to porn sites. The average visit lasts 6 minutes and 29 seconds.
- There are around 42 million porn websites, which totals around 370 million pages of porn.
- The average age that a child is first exposed to porn is 11 years old, and 94 percent of children will see porn by the age of 14.
- Fifty-six percent of American divorces involve one party having an “obsessive interest” in pornographic websites.
- Seventy percent of Christian youth pastors report that they have had at least one teen come to them for help in dealing with pornography in the past 12 months.
- Sixty-eight percent of church-going men and over 50 percent of pastors view porn regularly. Of young Christian adults 18-24 years old, 76 percent actively search for porn.
- Thirty-three percent of women aged 25 and below

search for porn at least once per month.

- Only 13 percent of self-identified Christian women say they never watch porn—87 percent of Christian women have watched porn.
- Fifty-five percent of married men and 25 percent of married women say they watch porn at least once a month.
- Fifty-seven percent of pastors say porn addiction is the most damaging issue in their congregation. Sixty-nine percent say porn has adversely impacted the church.

For many others, their all-consuming vice is an addiction to hard drugs, immoral sex, alcohol, and even video games. The Devil's tactic is to convince us with the lie that we are helpless. He says we cannot do anything about our human desires. And in believing this lie, some say, "I'm only human." As it happened to Peter, it happens to us. It only dawned on Peter that he was denying Jesus when he did it the third time. But thank God, earlier, Jesus had prayed for Peter. He told Peter, "Satan has asked to sift all of you as wheat. But I have prayed for you, Simon, that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned back, strengthen your brothers." (Luke 22:31-32 NIV). If you feel you are in a similar situation as Peter, remember that Jesus has prayed for you. Do not

believe the Devil's lie that you cannot recover. Jesus expects you to get back up, and when you do so, you must encourage others as I am doing in this book. You can rise again.

Fervently seek God's face: "Seek and deeply long for the Lord and His strength [His power, His might]; Seek and deeply long for His face and His presence continually." (Psalm 105:3-5 AMP) No matter what happens to you, don't stop seeking God's face. Maintain a prayer and Bible -reading routine, even when you don't feel like it. Keep asking God for His strength, faith, and presence continually. God's strength lies in His presence.

LIVE SCENARIO

Mr. A (a young adult) reached out to me one fateful afternoon. He was so worried about his spiritual life. His desire for God had dwindled so much that he found it difficult to speak to God every day. He had developed a strong desire for immorality. His new environment was full of temptations, especially as an amateur teacher in a high school. He confessed to lusting after the girl students, who also dress seductively in the school. He was very far away from the closest church venue where he could worship with other believers. At this time, he had given up and was just ready to go all in with the Devil. But thank God for His mercy.

It is not my usual attitude to rush in with advice and counsel without asking the Holy Spirit to guide me. So, I prayer-

fully shared several things with him. I took him through the following:

Devotion

The Devil's tactic is to draw you away from the presence of God, out of the hedge He has built around you so he can strike you badly. My advice is to never stop seeking God, no matter how you feel. Maintain your quiet time, even when you do not feel like it. Keep praying to God, even in your mess. Don't stop asking for God's mercy. God is experienced in cleaning up messes. Don't stop reading the Bible. God will keep speaking until you hear. He loves you that much. Don't give up on your spiritual life.

Sermons and Talks

Lust is a symptom and sign of a spiritual disease. Paul advised the Galatians to walk in the Spirit and they would not fulfill the lust of the flesh. When you starve the flesh, you strengthen the Spirit. And when you feed the flesh, it gets so big it chokes out the Spirit. Feed yourself with good messages and talks from reputable men of God. Let God direct you to the right people he can use to speak to you. Consistently surround yourself with these people weekly, and you will be surprised how God speaks. Once you open a permanent channel for God to speak to you, He will surely do so. The Word of

God feeds the Spirit and cleanses and strengthens the soul. In Psalm 119:19, David asked, “How can a young person stay on the path of purity?” and he answered himself, “By living according to your word.” The Word of God keeps you pure. Paul said in Romans 12:2: “But be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” The Word of God is the tool used for the renewing of the mind. The more the mind is renewed, the more you are transformed into what God wants you to be.

Music

Many young people risk the health of their spiritual lives for the pleasures of the flesh, and the outcome has never been pleasing. One tool the Devil uses to breed lust, sensuality, and seduction is music. It is not surprising that we have so many carnal and worldly songs with very nice rhythms, beats, rhymes, chords, and cultural streams but with demonic-inspired lyrics because the Devil himself was a musician in heaven. Every song creates an atmosphere—one reason why songs are sung in the church. Most songs invite the Spirit behind the inspiration. Be careful of the songs you listen to. Songs are channels through which spirits communicate with your spirit. Surround yourself with spiritual and heavenly songs; internalize the lyrics and let the Spirit flow through the songs into your spirit.

Remove triggers

One question I asked this young man was “What triggers you?” He confessed to always going through certain profiles on social media that he bookmarked and some other websites. He also confessed to being triggered by the ladies he was tutoring in the school where he teaches. The goal of this discussion was for him to identify these triggers and remove them. This is where discipline comes into play. It was difficult for him to delete his social media applications from his phone. But it is something he had to do if he wanted a change in his life. You cannot swim in the mud, and don’t expect to be stained. Ask the pig! You must deliberately create an environment for purity, physically, digitally, emotionally, and in all ways. It takes discipline to ensure purity. There are many applications and types of software that have been invented by Christian bodies to block access to internet sources of temptations and lust.

Have an accountability partner

Lastly, we discussed why he needed an accountability partner. He needed someone he could trust when he fell, not just to let the person know but also for prayers. Reaching out to the person anytime he fell eventually helped him to develop a stronger drive for purity, to avoid always reaching out to re-

port. This can also be achieved by using software that notifies the accountability partner anytime the agreement is violated.

FULFILLING PURPOSE

In writing to Timothy, Paul said,

For He delivered us and saved us and called us with a holy calling [a calling that leads to a consecrated life—a life set apart—a life of purpose], not because of our works [or because of any personal merit—we could do nothing to earn this], but because of His purpose and grace [His amazing, undeserved favor] which was granted to us in Christ Jesus before the world began [eternal ages ago], but now [that extraordinary purpose and grace] has been fully disclosed and realized by us through the appearing of our Savior Christ Jesus who [through His incarnation and earthly ministry] abolished death [making it null and void] and brought life and immortality to light through the gospel. (2 Timothy 1:9 AMP)

Paul made it clear to Timothy that a life of purpose originates from the life of God. Even though the concept of purpose has become a very common subject today, it is important to know, as I said before, you cannot find purpose until you find God. Achievements in life can make you successful, but purpose makes you fulfilled. Not every successful person feels fulfilled. The worst thing that can happen to a man is having success without fulfillment. Purpose brings that satisfaction

to life. Money without satisfaction can make a man miserable.

“Achievements in life can make you successful,
but purpose makes you fulfilled.

So, you might ask, what is purpose? In my definition, purpose is that thing God wants you to do at a particular point in time to bring glory to His name. The goal is to glorify God, but at each phase of your life, there will be a specific assignment that God wants you to do and finish. If you follow God's direction, you will notice a string of all those assignments. As you finish one assignment, you are linked to the next. They are all connected. A major part of your walk in life is discerning what assignment (purpose) God has for you at a particular time. Knowing this makes a difference in your life. When growing up, I knew some very intelligent classmates who helped others with their assignments. They were so busy with other people, they forgot they had their own work to do until a very late hour. So, they rushed their assignments and missed the details they would not have if they had made their work a priority. You must be careful in life not to be so busy doing other people's assignments that you forget what God wants you to do.

In my few years of life, I have had to move from one location to another, within the states and interstates, and across

countries, progressing in life, and fulfilling my purpose. One thing I always want to find out anywhere I go to is what God wants me to do. Sometimes, it might not be what I want or what other people want for me, but it should always be God's will. I remember volunteering in my birth country to provide community services in a program every graduate must engage in as part of the process to prove he graduated from college. Another unique aspect of this program is you are randomly assigned to any state within the country to serve for one year. That year, I was sent to a very remote and rural area in the southern part of the country. I have never lived in a rural area in my life. The village I was sent to lies between several mountains and was known for hosting some Chimpanzees. I was really scared as I traveled there, especially as most of the journey could only be done by road. I had opportunities to relocate to a city or a town, but I didn't get the direction from God to do so. Instead, God kept giving me words of assurance of His presence in this unknown and very strange place. After one year, I was happy I had obeyed God. I ended up being part of a great family of God, featured in several concerts, became the acting pastor of the local church, had opportunities to impact and influence lives, and, as a medical doctor, applied my skills to save many lives. When I was leaving that village, I felt satisfied because I knew I had fulfilled my purpose. Yes, I might have gotten more money in the town or city but

perhaps without fulfillment. More success does not always equate to more fulfillment.

Fulfilling your purpose requires following the plan God has for you. I used to say Jesus said “follow me” first before social media did. Nowadays, we follow people on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, and other platforms. I am not sure how many followers Jesus would have had on social media if He were alive today. But when He called the disciples, He said “Follow me.” You can tell that except for Judas, the disciples followed Jesus and despite the challenges, they fulfilled their purpose. Jesus kept to His word; He made them who they ought to have been.

We desire to follow God’s Word, will, and way. His words are always true. His will controls the wheels of our lives. His ways are of peace to give us an expected end. As you follow God, He will make you. Your responsibility is to follow, while His responsibility is to make you. You don’t have to worry about how He does it. God will mold you, activate the potential in you, keep you from the plans of the enemy, and elevate you to the position He has in mind for you.

“As you follow God, He will make you. Your responsibility is to follow, while His responsibility is to make you.”